

Paper C: Speaking & Listening



THE LONDON SCHOOL
OF ECONOMICS AND
POLITICAL SCIENCE ■

Overview



1. Warmer (tongue twisters)
2. Review of Paper C: Part 2
3. Practice of Paper C: Part 3

Tongue twisters are a good way of exercising all the mouth muscles & improving articulation. Start slow, then build up speed.



1. Three theoretical thinkers thoroughly thought through theories of gender.
2. Researchers rarely reach agreement on the roles and rules shaping gender relations.
3. Women who work worldwide worry when workplace values weaken.
4. Graduate researchers gathered great data on the growing gender gap.
5. Leading legislators linked limited leadership opportunities to labour market inequalities.
6. Debating diversity, doctoral students discussed deeply rooted gender differences.
7. Fairness frameworks frequently fail to fully reflect fluid forms of gender identity.
8. Statistics students studied stubborn stereotypes shaping society's expectations of gender.

Paper A: Part Two



- Last week, you practiced 2-minute presentations on the topic of social media.
- The next 3 slides have questions about gender.
- Your teacher will divide you into 3 groups. Each group should look at a different question, discuss possible answers and prepare a 2-minute response.

Step One:



Your teacher will divide you into 3 groups. Each group should discuss the question they are given and prepare a 2-minute response.

Group 1: Do you think gender roles are changing?

Group 2: Fewer than a third of the UK's most influential jobs are held by women. What, if anything should be done to change this?

Group 3: Do you think gender stereotypes are harmful?

Step Two:

- Now form groups of 2-3 with students who have prepared different questions.
- Listen to each other's presentations and give each other constructive feedback: what went well & what could be improved?



Step Three (optional)



If you have time, you could:

- a) Repeat your presentation making the improvements that were suggested.
- b) Repeat your presentation using a different argumentation structure (justification, rebuttal or synthesis).
- c) Give a 2-minute presentation on a different question e.g. if you prepared a presentation for Q1, you could now try answering Q2 or Q3.

Paper C: Part 3



Participating in seminars & group work can be difficult for many international students.

Some reasons include:

- Not finding the **opportunity** to speak
- Not having the **time** to formulate a response
- Feeling unable to contribute something **interesting/relevant**
- Not wanting to **risk** saying something “wrong” (linguistic or academic)
- Lack of **confidence/experience** with public speaking

Part 3 of Paper C is a discussion; preparing for Part 3 will help you with seminars & group work.

Paper C: Part Three



- In Part 3, the examiner will give you a list of questions on one of the LN905 topics.
- You do not have to answer all the questions and you do not have to answer the questions in order.
- The examiner will not intervene in the discussion; you are expected to manage it independently.

Paper C: Part Three



A few things to consider:

- You should all contribute to the discussion.
- You will get marks for expressing your views clearly and coherently.
- You will also get marks for interaction with the other students, so it is important to include them and to respond to what they say.
- You should make sure your voice is heard but you should not dominate the discussion.
- On average, your responses to the questions should be 30-60 seconds long.

Paper C: Part Three



Working in groups of 3-5, discuss the questions on the next slide (10-15 minutes).

Note: in the assessment, you will be in groups of 2-3 and the discussion will take 7-8 minutes.



1. In what ways are men and women be treated differently?
2. In the UK, almost 8 in 10 companies pay their male employees more than their female employees. Why do you think this is and what could be done about it?
3. Since 2008 Norway has had a mandatory 40% quota for business boards. However, this has been criticised. Do think quotas to increase the number of women in on business boards are a good idea?
4. Do you believe gender is one of the great structural divides in our society? What other divides are there?

How many of the following did you do in the discussion?



1. Agree with someone
2. Disagree politely
3. Ask for clarification
4. Give an example
5. Challenge an idea
6. Summarise another speaker's view
7. Hedge a claim
8. Ask someone else's opinion
9. Highlight complexity
10. Refer to evidence
11. Build on another person's idea
12. Ask a follow-up question

Task



- Work in groups of 2-3
- You will take part in 4 'mini-discussions' (3-4 minutes)
- For each 'mini-discussion', you should try to use the 3 skills that are listed – you can find 'helpful language' for these skills on Moodle.

Mini-Discussion 1



Question:

To what extent do gender stereotypes still influence people's educational and career choices?

Functions to practise:

- a) Give an example
- b) Ask for clarification
- c) Refer to evidence

Mini-Discussion 2



Question:

Has gender equality improved significantly in recent decades, or do major inequalities remain?

Functions to practise:

- a) Agree with someone
- b) Disagree politely
- c) Hedge a claim

Mini-Discussion 3



Question:

Should organisations use gender quotas to increase representation in leadership positions?

Functions to practise:

- a) Challenge an idea
- b) Build on another person's idea
- c) Ask someone else's opinion

Mini-Discussion 4



Question:

How should societies respond to changing ideas about gender?

Functions to practise:

- a) Summarise another speaker's view
- b) Highlight complexity
- c) Ask a follow-up question

Reflection



How did you do? Did you manage all 12 skills?
Which ones were the most difficult?

